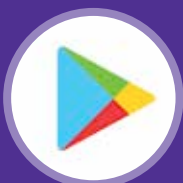


DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUs, IT'S ALL
HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
This month, we explore the state of the head-phone market in India, we delve into the origins of plugs and outlets, we learn more about conversational AI in devworx and a lot more.



Google wants its 30 per cent

Google is doubling down on ensuring that it gets its commission from apps that have been circumventing its Play Store billing system. In a blog post, Google stated that the commission policy is only applicable to less than 3 per cent of developers who have their apps on the Google Play store and has given these devs one year to comply.
<http://dgit.in/thurdypercent>

WHAT'S NEW

Amazon announces 13 new devices under Echo, Ring, Eero and more

Amazon announced product refreshes to their popular Echo and Ring line-ups while introducing new products and services as well. First in line are the All-new Echo speakers priced for \$99.99 followed by the smaller All-new Echo Dot, Dot with Clock and Dot Kits speakers. The All-new Echo Show 10, an upgrade to Amazon's display-enabled speakers, was also announced for \$249.99. A new entrant were the Eero 6 and Eero Pro 6 Wi-Fi 6 Mesh router systems priced at \$129.99 and \$229.99, respectively. For their Ring home security system, Amazon unveiled the Ring Always Home Cam, a



surveillance drone that flies around your home when you want it to. A new avenue that the Ring cameras

expanded into are cars as you now have Ring Car Alarm and Ring Car Cam in the picture. Lastly, Amazon announced its own game streaming service called Luna+ which is designed to work with PC, Mac, iOS, Android and the Fire TV. As of now, access to Luna+ is limited by invitation only.
<http://dgit.in/AmFallEv20>

Coalition for App Fairness vs Apple

Several companies including Spotify Technology, Epic Games, Proton Technologies, News Media Europe, Basecamp LLC and Match Group Inc have banded together to form a nonprofit group that goes by the name Coalition for App Fairness. The new group are gearing up to take on Apple and other app-store operators to bring about changes to their respective marketplaces. Key objectives include fighting what they term



are excessive commissions sought by the marketplace owners for app purchases and the unfair practices they indulge in to stifle competing services. It should be noted that Spotify has been in a PR war with Apple

over the latter's unfair practices to stifle Spotify and favour Apple Music. The recent announcement of Apple One has given Spotify more reason to gear up for a fight. Epic Games, on the other hand, sued both Apple and Alphabet Inc over the removal of Fortnite from the respective app stores after Epic introduced their own payment gateway in Fortnite to bypass commissions sought by the marketplace owners.
<http://dgit.in/CoAF>



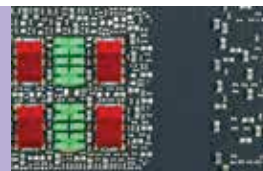
Microsoft's Project Natck deemed successful

Microsoft's multi-year project to test the feasibility of underwater data centers recently ended in September. Project Natck concluded that underwater data centres are reliable, practical and use energy sustainably compared to their terrestrial counterparts.
<http://dgit.in/ProjNat>



China bans Scratch programming language

Scratch, a programming language developed to help kids learn to code has been banned by China. A state-run outlet reported that Projects in Scratch contain "humiliating, fake, and libelous content about China".
<http://dgit.in/NoScratchInChina>



NVIDIA RTX 3000 cards crashing

NVIDIA's RTX 3080 and 3090 have seen multiple reports of crashing owing to the kind of capacitors used under the GPU. Numerous vendors have acknowledged the issue and have started making changes to counter the crashes. NVIDIA has already released a new driver to address the issue.
<http://dgit.in/rtxcrash>